

EMERGENCY AND WEATHER-RELATED OPERATIONS

A. Authority.

The Superintendent or designee may order the closing, the delay in opening, or the early dismissal of any or all schools and or events and activities in order to protect the safety and welfare of LCPS students and staff. Unless employees are notified that their work schedule is changed because of adverse weather or emergency conditions, it is expected that all employees will work according to the terms of their contract and School Board policies. During adverse weather or emergency conditions, employees follow guidelines from the Superintendent or designee related to work schedules. The Superintendent is authorized to promulgate regulations to implement this policy as needed.

B. Process.

1. Decision Matrix. The Chief Operations Officer shall be responsible for recommending to the Superintendent or designee that operations at individual schools, or all schools, be closed or altered for the day for reasons of inclement weather or other disruptions or emergencies.

2. Relocation.

- a. In the event of a disruption or emergency closure to a school, students and staff may be relocated to a nearby school site for reunification and/or dismissal.
- b. If the emergency causes temporary closure of the building, students may be assigned to an alternative school site for an interim period.

3. After-School and Weekend Activities. If the school campus is closed or part of the building where the event is being held is closed for any reason, any planned event/activity therein will be canceled.

C. Operational Definitions.

1. Inclement Weather Disruption. An event where normal activities are affected or disrupted due to severe or unfavorable weather conditions, including, but not limited to, snow, ice, sleet, air quality, extreme temperature, tornado, hurricane, tropical storm, and/or extreme wind.

2. Utility Disruption. An event where there is an interruption or failure of essential public utilities, which are critical services essential for daily operations. Utility disruptions could occur with electricity/power, water or sewer, gas, and/or information technology.

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3. Infrastructure Disruption. The interruption or failure of the physical structure or essential systems of a building or facility. An infrastructure disruption could be caused by building damage, essential building system failure, roadway accessibility limitations, and/or a disturbance in the area.

4. Civil Disturbance. An event where a group of individuals engage in collective actions that disrupt public order. Civil disturbance often involves violent or disruptive protests or demonstrations, riots, strikes, and/or other forms of civil unrest.

5. Public Health Emergency. A situation where a community, region, or country face a significant and imminent threat to the health and well-being of its population. Public health emergencies have various causes, including, but not limited to: infectious disease outbreaks, natural disasters, chemical or radiological incidents, and/or bioterrorism.

D. Duration - Virtual Learning. In the event of a longer-term disruption or emergency closure, the Superintendent may authorize virtual learning days per authorization from the Virginia Department of Education and in accordance with Policy 6610 (Contingency Planning).

E. Notification/Communication. Whenever possible, decisions to close or delay school will be communicated internally and to media outlets over local radio and television stations, the LCPS website, and mass notification system utilizing tools, such as phone, text, and email.

Adopted: 12/12/23

Legal Refs.: Code of Virginia, 1950, as amended, §§ [22.1-70](#), [22.1-78](#), [22.1-98](#)

Cross Refs: [Policy 6610 \(Contingency Planning\)](#)